

All biosecurity requirements must be met before [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#) requirements apply.

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions and [food safety requirements](#).

We classify imported food that presents a potential medium or high risk to public health as [risk food](#). All risk food is listed in the [Imported Food Control Order 2019](#).

Bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products are classified as risk food

This includes raw or processed:

- clams
- cockles
- mussels
- oysters
- pipis
- scallops.

Processing includes cooking, pasteurising, heating, drying, marinating and smoking.

Bivalve mollusc products are foods that contain 50% or more bivalve mollusc meat.

Exclusions

- Refer to the [foreign government certificates](#) section for certification exclusions.
- Refer to the [inspection and testing](#) section for hazard specific exclusions.
- Food from [New Zealand](#).

Restrictions on oyster imports

Oysters sourced from these areas are not permitted for import:

- Republic of Korea
- Northern and Western marine areas of Hiroshima Bay, Japan
- Marine area of Kure Bay in Hiroshima Prefecture, Japan.

This restriction excludes oysters that are [retorted](#) and [shelf stable](#).

Consignments of oysters from Japan must have their source verified in writing by a recognised [competent authority](#).

Foreign government certificates

Consignments of bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products must be covered by a government [certification arrangement](#).

These products are excluded from foreign government certification requirements:

- [retorted](#) and [shelf stable](#) products, including condiments and sauces
- dried products, including chilled soup mixes containing dried bivalve molluscs.

Learn more about [how a national competent authority in an exporting country can apply for a foreign government certificate arrangement](#).

Declaring certificates

When lodging a [Full Import Declaration \(FID\)](#), use the correct ICS document code and certificate number for the food.

Import requirements vary according to the relevant certification arrangement. In most cases, you can only import bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products if the harvesting country, and the exporting country, are both listed.

Check [BICON](#) for country specific requirements.

Countries included in this list may have a finalised certification arrangement with Australia or may be negotiating an arrangement and permitted to continue exporting while negotiations are underway.

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	Servicio Nacional de Sanidad y Calidad Agroalimentaria (SENASA) (National Food Safety and Quality Service)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement: Mandatory certification

Type of information	Content
	Canadian Food Inspection Agency (CFIA)

National
competent
authority:

Recognised certificate title:	Health Certificate for the export of bivalve molluscs and bivalve molluscs products for human consumption from Canada to Australia / Certificat sanitaire pour l'exportation de mollusques bivalves et de produits à base de mollusques bivalves destinés à la consommation humaine du Canada vers l'Australie
ICS document code:	BIVALVECAN

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	Servicio Nacional de Pesca y Acuicultura (SERNAPESCA) (National Fisheries and Aquaculture Service)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	General Administration of Customs of the People's Republic of China (GACC)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement: Mandatory certification

Content	Information/ Status
National competent authority	Irish Sea-Fisheries Protection Authority (ISFPA)
Recognised certificate title:	Health certificate for processed bivalve molluscs intended for human consumption to Australia
ICS document code:	BIVALVEIRE

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements
Current restrictions	Oysters sourced from these areas are not permitted for import: Consignments of oysters from Japan must have their source verified in writing by a recognised competent authority .

Certificate requirement

Content	Information/ Status
National competent authority	Ministry of Oceans and Fisheries (MOF) National Fisheries Quarantine Management Service (NFQS)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements
Current restrictions	Oysters sourced from the Republic of Korea are not permitted for import.

Certificate requirement

Content	Information/ Status
National competent authority	The Food Safety and Quality Division (FSQD) (Ministry of Health Malaysia)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements

No certification requirement.

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	Organismo Nacional de Sanidad Pesquera (SANIPES) (National Fisheries Health Agency)
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement: Mandatory certification

Type of information	Content
National competent authority:	Ministerio de Agricultura, Pesca y Alimentación (MAPA) (Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Food)
Recognised certificate title:	Veterinary certificate for export to Australia of processed bivalve molluscs for human consumption
ICS document code:	BIVALVESPN

Certificate requirement

Content	Information/ Status
National competent authority	Bureau of Standards, Metrology and Inspection (BSMI) Assessment of application in progress
Mandatory certification	Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	Department of Fisheries (DOF) Assessment of application in progress
Mandatory certification	

Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement

Content	Information/ Status
National competent authority	Department for Environment, Food & Rural Affairs (DEFRA)
	Assessment of application in progress
Mandatory certification	Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Certificate requirement:

(consignments shipped before 19 August 2026)

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA)
Mandatory certification	Health certificate for processed bivalve molluscs intended for human consumption to Australia

Certificate requirement: Mandatory certification

(consignments shipped on board from 19 August 2026)

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA)
Recognised certificate title:	Certificate to a foreign government: Food for human consumption
ICS document code:	BIVALVEUSA

Certificate requirement

Content	Information / Status
National competent authority	The National Agro-Forestry-Fisheries Quality Assurance Department (NAFIQAD) Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development of Vietnam
Mandatory certification	Assessment of application in progress Trade can continue as per current arrangements

Important reminder to importers

Bivalve molluscs and bivalve molluscs products (excluding retorted and, shelf stable or dried products) that either originate from, or arrive from a country not listed on this page, will be directed for supervised re-export or supervised destruction at the importers expense.

Community Protection (CP) questions

You may need to answer one or more of these CP questions when lodging your [full import declaration](#):

IFIS: Are the goods uncanned oysters (including pearl meat) harvested from either the Republic of Korea, or the northern and western marine areas of Hiroshima Bay, or the marine area of Kure Bay in Hiroshima prefecture, Japan?

IFIS: Do the goods contain 50% or more bivalve mollusc meat?

IFIS: Are the goods heat treated bivalve molluscs that require refrigeration (chilled or frozen) and do not require further cooking before consumption?

Inspection and testing

We refer consignments of bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products for analytical testing. During inspection, we will also conduct a visual and label assessment.

Details on analytical testing for bivalve molluscs can be found in the food safety requirements case in the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) under 'Molluscs and mollusc products'.

Food safety risks

Food Standards Australia New Zealand (FSANZ) has published [advice about the risk of bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products](#).

These products present a potential medium or high risk to public health for:

- hepatitis A
- norovirus
- domoic acid
- paralytic shellfish poison.

[Ready-to-eat](#) processed bivalve molluscs are a potential medium or high risk for *Listeria monocytogenes*.

To make sure there are food safety controls in place to manage hazards associated with bivalve molluscs we require [foreign government certificates](#) for imports of this food.

Voluntary foreign government certification arrangements

We have a [voluntary certification arrangement](#) in place with Thailand for processed bivalve molluscs. Consignments of processed bivalve molluscs from Thailand with a recognised government certificate have a reduced rate of inspection and testing.

Certificate requirements

Type of information To include

National competent authority:	Ministry of Agriculture and Cooperatives – Department of Fisheries
Recognised certificate title:	Health Certificate for fishery and aquaculture products originating in Thailand
Additional requirement:	The certificate must identify that the food has been sourced from an establishment approved by the Department of Fisheries, Thailand .
ICS document code:	DOFHCTH

Glossary

Competent authority

The government authority or official body authorised by the government that is responsible for the setting of regulatory food safety requirements and/or for the organization of official controls including enforcement.

Heat treated

Heat treated includes pasteurised, cooked and smoked.

Ready-to-eat

Food is ready-to-eat if it is ordinarily consumed in the same state as that in which it is sold.

To avoid doubt, food is not ordinarily consumed in the same state as that in which it is sold if, before it is consumed, it requires further processing (such as cooking) to reduce any pathogenic microorganisms potentially present in the food to safe levels.

Retorted

Animal products are retorted if they are heated in a hermetically sealed container to a minimum core temperature of 100°C, obtaining an Fo value of at least 2.8.

Shelf stable

Goods are shelf-stable if the:

- goods have been commercially manufactured
- goods have been packaged by the manufacturer
- goods are in that package
- package has not been opened or broken
- goods are able to be stored in the package at room or ambient temperature, and
- goods do not require refrigeration or freezing before the package is opened.

Version history

Date	Amendment details
11/08/2026	Add USA certification content requirements to accordion list.
08/07/2026	Clarified permissions for country of origin and country of export
01/07/2026	Removed India and Indonesia certification content requirements from accordion list.
28/05/2026	Add Ireland certification content requirements to accordion list.
13/02/2026	Add Canada certification content requirements to accordion list.
10/12/2025	Update the description for 'bivalve mollusc products' to provide clarity on the risk food.
	Add Spain certification content requirements to accordion list. Delete analytical testing
01/09/2025	table and refer to BICON. Remove factsheet on applying for foreign government certification and direct to web page.
25/10/2024	Amend the testing table to include additional information that only food not packaged for retail sale may be excluded from Escherichia coli (E. coli) testing.
23/09/2024	Removal of date for the voluntary foreign government certification with Thailand.
	Additional information added to clarify certification exclusions for bivalve mollusc
28/11/2023	products and a note added to testing table regarding option for an importer declaration for Escherichia coli (E. coli) testing.
09/11/2023	Additional competent authority added to Korea. Updated current restrictions for Japan. Inserted a definition for "Dried" in the Glossary section.
06/11/2023	Additional countries added to the webpage. Including Ireland, Malaysia, Republic of Korea, Taiwan and United Kingdom.
	Amend the webpage to update with the list of countries that are currently in the process
26/10/2023	of negotiating a certification arrangement with the department to enable the export of bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products to Australia.
27/09/2023	Amend the webpage to update the exclusions for mixed food that and testing for biotoxins (domoic acid and paralytic shellfish poison).
12/4/2023	Amend the webpage to update the link to the list of fish processing establishments approved by the Department of Fisheries, Thailand.

29/3/2023	Addition of a bivalve mollusc and bivalve mollusc product factsheet to the webpage.
01/12/2021	The date of commencement has been extended to 9 November 2023, for consignments of bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products, excluding those that are both retorted and shelf-stable, or dried (not semi-dried), that must be covered by a recognised foreign government certificate.
10/11/2020	From November 2022, consignments of bivalve molluscs and bivalve mollusc products, excluding those that are both retorted and shelf stable, or dried (not semi-dried) must be covered by a recognised foreign government certificate.
12/04/2017	Commence analysis of biotoxins in retorted bivalve molluscs and reduce range of foods analysed for paralytic shellfish poisons.
1/5/2014	Replaces Imported Food Notice 09/12 Tests applied to risk category foods

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/bivalve-molluscs>